



FOOD FOR THOUGHT

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THE SECRET SAUCE TO SPORTING SUCCESS

While nutrition does transform good athletes into champions, parents, schools and holistic health play **crucial roles in shaping** India's future sports stars.

In my exciting journey alongside some of India's finest athletes — from Olympic medallist Kenneth Bednarek to wrestling champion Sushil Kumar and cricket superstars like Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma — one thing is crystal clear: nutrition is the secret sauce that turns good athletes into legends. What we put on our plates isn't just fuel; it's the magic ingredient that powers greatness. Winning isn't just about the hours spent training; it's about what's on the menu. This realisation underscores a fundamental truth: a well-nourished body is the foundation of sporting excellence.

Parents as the MVPs in young athletes' nutrition

Athletes might be the ones on the field, but guess who's the real MVP? Parents! They are the ones who shape those future sports stars with the power of nutrition. Yet only 30 per cent of them fully understand what their kids need on their plates.

- **More fruits and veggies = more wins:** These colourful powerhouses are packed with vitamins and minerals that turn kids into champs.
 - **No sugar please:** Cut out the sugary drinks and watch the energy soar — just like that young footballer from Chennai, who went from sluggish to supercharged with just a few small changes.
- Parents are the real all-stars, setting their kids up for victory both on and off the field!

Turning nutrition into a fun adventure

Who says nutrition has to be boring? Let's make healthy eating a fun and exciting journey! Think of it like a treasure hunt — only that the treasure is lifelong health and athletic success. In India, where 14.4 million kids are

battling rising obesity rates, making nutrition fun isn't just important, it's essential.

- **Interactive games and challenges:** These can make learning about food fun! Imagine kids competing to create the most colourful (and nutritious) plates or discovering the 'superpowers' of different fruits and veggies.
- **Healthy eating = future success:** By making nutrition an adventure, we're not just feeding kids' bodies — we're fuelling their futures as champions.

The power of a holistic health game plan

Nutrition is just one piece of the puzzle. To truly excel, athletes need a holistic approach to health — think of it as their secret game plan. But here's the kicker: only half of India's teachers are clued in on health and nutrition. That's like trying to win a match without knowing the rules!

- **Schools could be the ultimate training ground:** Imagine a world where health and nutrition are taught like life's most valuable playbook, preparing young athletes for success both in and out of the arena.
- **Building a strong foundation:**